



Community Update May 8th 2020

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9AQX9UvBDJ0
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Municipal Meeting & Community Update Report

Meeting Date: May 8, 2020

Presiding Officer: Mayor Dan Ridenour (City of Muncie)

Special Guest: Dr. Jeffrey Mearns, President of Ball State University

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee work session was held prior to this broadcast.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** **00:00:09** Mayor Dan Ridenour called the daily municipal briefing and community update to order on May 8, 2020, welcoming special guest Ball State University President Jeffrey Mearns.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mayor Dan Ridenour
 - **Featured Guest:** President Jeffrey Mearns (Ball State University)
 - **Absent/Excused:** None noted.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The session focused on COVID-19 pandemic updates, community cooperation, and local institutional responses. Formal ceremonial openings (invocation, Pledge of Allegiance) were omitted from this broadcast format.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not applicable.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(This session was structured as an informational municipal briefing and leadership Q&A rather than a formal legislative voting meeting. No ordinances, resolutions, or formal contracts were brought forward for board action or votes.)

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No open public comment period or citizen forum was conducted during this administrative broadcast session.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **00:00:32 COVID-19 Statistics for Delaware County:** Mayor Ridenour reported 1,920 total tests administered, 213 positive cases, approximately 1,700 symptomatic individuals who tested negative, and 15 reported deaths.
 - **00:01:05 Public Health Reminders:** Emphasis placed on social distancing (maintaining a 6-foot distance), regular handwashing, and the use of face coverings to protect others.
 - **00:05:49 Ball State Fall Planning:** President Mearns announced that Ball State University is actively planning to resume on-campus instruction, teaching, and student residential operations in August under two parallel planning structures (Academic Planning and the "Trust" operational transition group).
 - **00:08:03 Financial & Operational Updates:** Major campus construction projects remain on pace and on budget. While housing, dining, and auxiliary budgets faced revenue impacts due to spring refunds and credits, the university's main operating budget anticipates a modest positive margin for the fiscal year ending June 30, while preparing contingencies for potential state appropriation adjustments and fall enrollment shifts.
 - **00:15:17 Community Philanthropy:** Mention of the second annual "One Ball State Day" fundraiser, which raised approximately \$530,000 from over 4,000 donors to support students, alongside a faculty-led fundraiser that procured and donated N95 and standard masks to university police, city personnel, and local hospitals.

- **Adjournment:** 00:18:04 Mayor Ridenour concluded the broadcast, reminding citizens to follow safety and social distancing guidelines, and announced that briefings would continue the following week.

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